The Dhāraṇī Called "Mother of Noble Avalokiteśvara"

Āryāvalokiteśvaramātā nāma dhāraṇī · Toh 909 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་སྤྱན་ར་གཟིགས་དབང་ཕྱུག་གི་ཡུམ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའོ་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called "Mother of Noble Avalokiteśvara," known in Sanskrit as Āryāvalokiteśvaramātā nāma dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Chenrezik Wangchuk gi Yum zhe jawé Zung, is a short scripture centered on a dhāraṇī, an incantation held to preserve and empower those who recite it. It opens in the city of Vaiśālī, where the Buddha is seated amid a great assembly of five hundred monks, among them the great disciple Śāriputra, and many bodhisattvas, among them Maitreya. The bodhisattva Samantabhadra rises from his seat, bows at the Buddha's feet, and addresses him, setting the scene for the teaching of a dhāraṇī associated with the mother of the noble bodhisattva of compassion, Avalokiteśvara. The work is Toh 909 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts gathered in the canon's collections of incantations and esoteric scriptures.

In the language of India: āryāvalokiteśvaramātā nāma dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called "Mother of Noble Avalokiteśvara."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling in the city of Vaiśālī, surrounded and attended by a great assembly. Surrounded and attended by five hundred monks, among them the great śrāvaka Śāriputra, and by a great many bodhisattva great beings, among them Maitreya, the Blessed One was seated on the seat that had been prepared for him.

The bodhisattva great being called Samantabhadra had gathered in that assembly and was seated there. He rose from his seat, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Blessed One, there is this great vidyā-mantra of the dhāraṇī called Mother of Avalokiteśvara, this basis of secret mantra. It was spoken in former times by the buddhas, the blessed ones of the past, the future and the present, and it is spoken now. When the Blessed One was a bodhisattva seeking awakening, he spoke it in former times for the sake of caring for all sentient beings, for their benefit, and so on up to the aims of bodhisattvas. It has become a father and a

mother to the sons and daughters of good family who follow the bodhisattva vehicle. It has become a refuge for those without refuge, an ally for those without allies, and a protector for those without protection. It brings all wrongdoing to an end. As soon as one hears that dhāraṇī, all one's wishes are completely fulfilled, and all vidyā-mantras are accomplished as well."

The Blessed One said: "Bodhisattva great being, formerly, when I was a bodhisattva seeking awakening, far beyond as many world systems as there are grains of sand in the river Ganges, and further beyond even that, in the world system called Sukhāvatī, there was the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the Perfectly Complete Buddha called Amitābha, who even now remains there, lives, abides and teaches the Dharma. In that very assembly was a brahmin called Lordly Light, who had attained the third bodhisattva ground. He proclaimed, explained and taught this dhāraṇī called Mother of Avalokiteśvara, this great queen of vidyā-mantras, to many hundreds of thousands of brahmins and to many trillions of sentient beings. I remember that as soon as they heard this dhāraṇī, all of them were freed from every wrongdoing that leads to downfall, and came to remember their former births.

"Bodhisattva great being, speak it! In times to come, in a world system thoroughly afflicted, the wrongdoing of beings who commit wrongs and who commit the acts of immediate retribution, wrongdoing amounting to many hundreds of thousands of trillions, will be exhausted. It will bring benefit and happiness, and it will become a protector for those without protection. I too grant permission and rejoice in it."

So the Blessed One declared. Then the bodhisattva great being Samantabhadra spoke these bases of secret mantra of the great vidyā-mantra of the dhāraṇī called Mother of Avalokiteśvara:

Homage to the Three Jewels.
Homage to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Amitābha.
Homage to the bodhisattva great being endowed with great compassion, noble Avalokiteśvara.

Having paid homage to them, I shall recite these bases of secret mantra of the great vidyā-mantra of the dhāraṇī called Mother of Noble Avalokiteśvara. May this vidyā be accomplished for me!

tadyathā ili mili cili mili kuntule kuntule kuntule sire sisire virāyā gauri gandhari drāmiḍe mātadgi pūkkasi kaṣḍāya māla caṇḍalī huṭṭya malini hūṃ dhudhu malini cile mile gṛhṇa saumya darśani kuru candra mukhe lābhu

mānayaṃte ārya dakṣiṇa bhuje sarva vidyānāma prasādhane sarva vidyānāma īśvari svāhā

This is the rite of this dhāraṇī, which is accomplished by recitation. As soon as one hears it, all karmic obscurations are purified. It protects from all fears. If one recites it at the three times of day, within seven days one will see the bodhisattva Samantabhadra. If one recites it with a mind that thinks of nothing else, within one month the great vidyā, the Mother of Noble Avalokiteśvara, will reveal herself, and one will also see noble Amitābha. One will become irreversible from awakening. One will remember one's former births and will also retain whatever one has heard. Wherever one is born, there one will never be parted from the true Dharma. One will have great wealth.

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, the bodhisattva great being Samantabhadra, those bodhisattvas, those monks, and the whole assembly rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the dhāraṇī called "Mother of Noble Avalokiteśvara."

It was translated and edited by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Dānaśīla and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé, and it was then revised and finalized according to the new terminology.

Translator's Notes

• The brahmin's name, Tibetan "Wangchuk Ö," could not be confidently matched to an attested Sanskrit form (perhaps Īśvaraprabha). It is therefore translated by meaning as "Lordly Light." In the line on the results of one month's recitation, the Tibetan "ma rig pa chen mo" is read as "mother, the great vidyā," not as "great ignorance."

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.